



The Concept of *Jihad* in Islam

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Meaning & Concepts

- The literal meaning of Jihad is “to struggle” or “to strive”
- **Definition:** To struggle in the way of Allah (SWT), through one’s life, wealth, speech or action.

Difference between Jihad and Qital

- **Qital:** Physically fighting in the way of Allah (SWT) against the enemies of Islam, under lawful Islamic authority.
- Jihad is a broader concept that includes every form of effort made for Allah’s cause, while Qital is a specific type of Jihad.
- **Jihad** is a **continuous duty** for every Muslim in different forms, while **Qital** becomes obligatory only in **specific circumstances** defined by Shariah.

Jihad in the Holy Quran

إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ ثُمَّ لَمْ يَرْتَابُوا وَجَاهَدُوا بِأَمْوَالِهِمْ وَأَنْفُسِهِمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أُولَئِكَ هُمُ الصَّادِقُونَ
(الحجرات: 15)

The 'true' believers are only those who believe in Allah and His Messenger—never doubting—and strive with their wealth and their lives in the cause of Allah. They are the ones true in faith.

وَالَّذِينَ جَاهَدُوا فِينَا لَنَهْدِيَنَّهُمْ سُبُلَنَا وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَمَعَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ (العنكبوت: 69)

And those who strive for Us - We will surely guide them to Our ways. And indeed, Allah is with the doers of good.

فَلَا تُطِيعِ الْكَافِرِينَ وَجَاهِدْهُمْ بِهِ جِهَادًا كَبِيرًا (الفرقان: 52)

So do not obey the disbelievers, and strive against them with it (the Qur'an) a great striving.

Qital in the Holy Quran

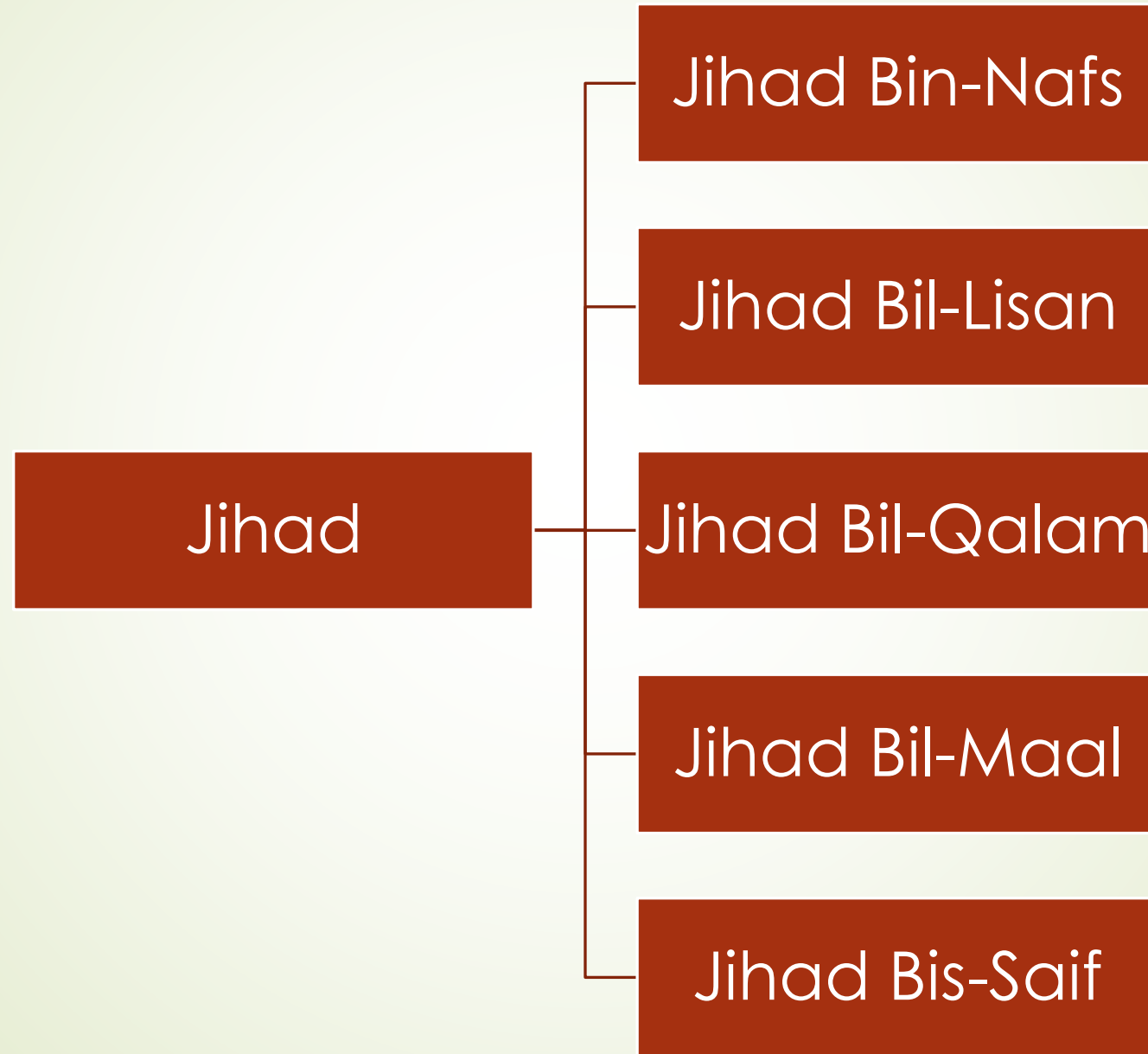
إِنَّ اللَّهَ اشْتَرَىٰ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَنْفُسَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ بِأَنَّ لَهُمُ الْجَنَّةَ يُقَاتِلُونَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَيَقْتُلُونَ وَيُقْتَلُونَ وَعْدًا عَلَيْهِ حَقًّا فِي التَّوْرَةِ وَالْإِنْجِيلِ وَالْقُرْآنِ وَمَنْ أَوْفَىٰ بِعَهْدِهِ مِنَ اللَّهِ فَاسْتَبْشِرُوا بِبَيْعِكُمُ الَّذِي بَايَعْتُمْ بِهِ وَذَلِكَ هُوَ الْفَوْزُ الْعَظِيمُ (التوبة: 111)

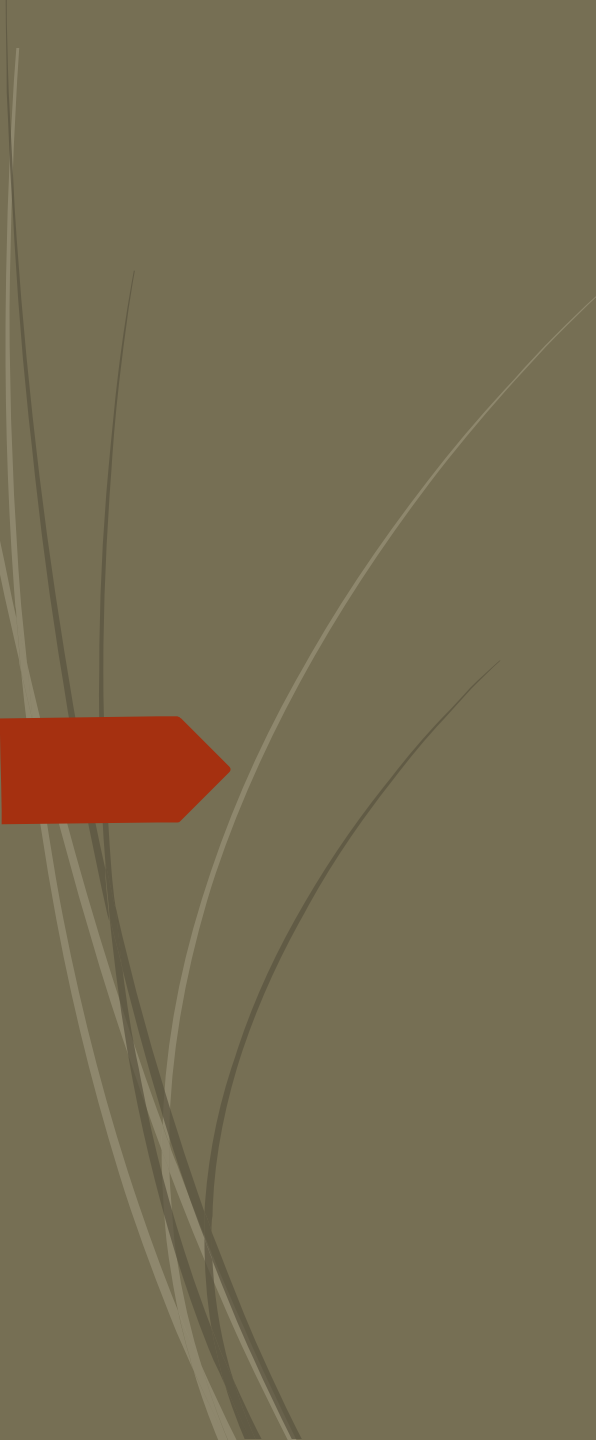
Indeed, Allah has purchased from the believers their lives and their properties [in exchange] for that they will have Paradise. They fight in the cause of Allah, so they kill and are killed. [It is] a true promise [binding] upon Him in the Torah and the Gospel and the Qur'an. And who is truer to his covenant than Allah? So rejoice in your transaction which you have contracted. And it is that which is the great attainment.

وَلَا تَحْسَبَنَّ الَّذِينَ قُتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَاتًا بَلْ أَحْيَاءٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ يُرْزَقُونَ (آل عمران: 169)

And never think of those who have been killed in the cause of Allah as dead. Rather, they are alive with their Lord, receiving provision

Types of *Jihad*





Which type of Jihad is
considered the most
virtuous (*Afzal*)?

Types of *Shaheed*

- **Haqeeqi Shaheed:** The one who martyred on the battlefield while fighting in the path of Allah (SWT).
- **Hukmi Shaheed:**
 - Martyrdom in Defense of Wealth, Life, and Family.
 - Who prayed for martyrdom but died a natural death.
 - Who dies due to plague (طاعون).
 - Who dies due to abdominal illness.
 - Who dies by burning in fire.
 - Who dies by drowning in water.
 - A woman who dies during pregnancy.
 - One who follows Sunnah during the difficult times.
 - One who sleeps in the state of wuzu and dies in the same state.
 - One who recites *Durood* 100 times daily.



Islamic Ethics during *Jihad*

- **No harm to non-combatants**
 - ❑ Women, children, elderly, and civilians
- **No destruction of crops or property**
 - ❑ Avoid damaging trees or homes unnecessarily
- **No torture or cruelty**
 - ❑ Prisoners of war must be treated humanely.
- **No breaking promises**
 - ❑ Agreements and treaties must be honored
- **Rights for Non-Muslim citizens**
 - ❑ Their rights are same as those for Muslims.